

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced

雅思口语高级

——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 7 Culture

Topic 4—Lesson 2(下篇)

A cultural event in your culture/country



IELTS Speaking Part 2 (10 minutes)

You will be given one minute to prepare to talk about the topic on the task card. You will have to talk for 1-2 minutes, and then the teacher will give you feedback for 2-3mins. (5 minutes)

Describe an important traditional event (in your culture/country).

You should say:

when this event is held

who attend this event

what people do during this event

and **explain why** this event is important.



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.3 Here is another model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (5 minutes)

Model 2

What and when this event is held: The important traditional event I wish to introduce to you is the Dragon Boat Festival, also known as the Duanwu Festival. It is celebrated annually on the fifth day of the fifth month according to the lunar calendar.

Who attends and what people do during this event: For thousands of years, this festival has **been characterised by** the custom of eating zongzi. On this special day, a kind of glutinous rice dumplings named zongzi will be made and eaten by the Chinese people. These are seen as the sacred offerings to Qu Yuan, a patriotic poet in ancient China who **committed suicide** by drowning himself in the Miluo River. The ingredients often include sticky rice, beans, chestnuts and pork, which are wrapped with bamboo leaves. The Duanwu Festival is also famous for its dragon boat races held to commemorate Qu Yuan. Customarily, such races often take place among different clans, villages and organisations, and the winners will be awarded medals, banners, jugs of wine, or even feasts.

Why this event is important: From my perspective, the great significance of this festival lies not just in its unique historic value, but also in the fact that the Chinese people have long preserved the golden virtues of **patriotism**, cooperation and teamwork. What's more, due to its profound cultural implications, the Chinese government has made the Dragon Boat Festival a major public holiday.

IV. IELTS Speaking Part 3 (10 mins)

1. Please answer the following question from Part 3. According to your answer, the teacher will give you feedback on how to improve your organisational skills. (5 minutes)

How to organise your answer in Part 3:

T: Topic Sentence + S: Supporting Details (Explanation/Examples)

What is the value of traditions?

T: According to my understanding, the essential value of traditions is related to morals and cultures.

S1: When a tradition like foot-binding becomes incompatible with people's values and beliefs, they are terminated; therefore, only the most useful and meaningful traditions survive the test of time, just like the immortal Chinese tradition of frugality.

S2: Besides, some traditions are passed down over generations and normally they reflect rich cultural values. These traditions can be regarded as the most precious cultural heritage from our ancestors, such as the Lantern Festival.

2. You will learn some key words and expressions from these questions. Pay attention to the structure of the underlined sentences, and the words in red. (5 minutes)

Key Words and Models

Why are some people more attracted to foreign cultures than their own cultures?



As I see it, some people have the "grass is greener on the other side" mentality. Honestly speaking, these types of people oftentimes place greater value on what they don't have rather than what they have, and this is also relatable to cultural differences. Also, I suspect that such individuals are attracted to foreign cultures simply because they do not want to be left out of experiencing any different customs and traditions that they may or may not feel are superior to their own cultures.

Do you think traditions will be lost in the future?



Due to the nature of traditions, it is inevitable that some will be lost in the future. For example, in China it was a tradition to set off fireworks, but now due to severe pollution problems this practice has started to fade away. Besides, traditions that are considered cruel or repressive, such as foot-binding, have already been abandoned. Therefore, traditions will always change and evolve over time, and some of them are bound to become obsolete.

V. Summary (5 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

be characterised by

commit suicide

patriotism

terminate

grass is greener on the other side

set off fireworks



Key Sentences

For thousands of years, this festival has **been characterised by** the custom of eating zongzi.

These are seen as the offerings to Qu Yuan, a patriotic poet in ancient China who **committed suicide** by drowning himself in the Miluo River.

The Chinese people have long preserved the golden virtues of **patriotism**, cooperation and teamwork.

When a tradition becomes incompatible with people's values and beliefs, they are **terminated**.

As I see it, some people have the "**grass is greener on the other side**" mentality.

For example, in China it was a tradition to **set off fireworks**, but now due to severe pollution problems this practice has started to fade away.

The next lesson will be **Unit 7 Topic 5 A foreign culture you are interested in.**